

Gender parity: In Paris, umpires and technical officials are evenly split between genders at hockey matches, with a 50:50 ratio. GETTYIMAGES

umpiring has not been a regular occurrence at the Olympic Games. In Paris, umpires and technical officials are evenly split between genders, with a 50:50 ratio.

"Gender equality is anchored into hockey's DNA, and FIH won't miss any opportunity to promote it. With the introduction of mixed-gender on-field umpiring at the Olympics, FIH is showcasing once more its determination towards a more gender-equal sport and society," said FIH president Tayyab Ikram.

Paris, the cycling capital

It's fitting that the country hosting one of the most iconic annual sporting events, the Tour de France, has successfully transformed Paris into the cycling capital. The authorities have used the opportunity presented by the Olympic Games to promote Paris's image as an environmentally friendly place, emphasising cycling. The city has a wide rail network, excellent tram and bus services, and a high number of expensive luxury cars and motorbikes on its roads. However, in 2015, a comprehensive plan to turn

the city into a cycling-friendly place was launched. The updated 2021-2026 plan expands on these commitments with increased investment and the creation of 180 km of new cycle lanes, reflecting a significant shift towards sustainable mobility in Paris.

It's now common to see people cycling on dedicated lanes to reach their workplaces and other destinations all over the city. Notably, these efforts have resulted in 11.2

per cent of journeys being made by bicycle, compared to 4.3 per cent by car. It's hoped that other cities will adopt similar strategies to reduce carbon emissions and promote healthier citizens.

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